



HS 254: Introduction to European Philosophy

Course Code	HS 254
Course Name	Introduction to European Philosophy
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Consent of the faculty member
Intended for	B.Tech.
Distribution	Elective
Approval	2nd Adhoc Senate (May 2012)

Course Contents

The Problem of Knowledge How do we come by knowledge? From Menos Paradox to Polanyis Tacit Knowing [10 Lectures]

The Problem of Justice From Platonic Communism to Marxist Dialectics; from the Polis to the Open Society; from isonomia to distributive justice [10 Lectures]

The Problem of Religion From the City of God to the City of Man; the Church and the State; The Saint and the Statesman; Transcendence and Immanence [10 Lectures]

The Problem of Technology From the Novum Organon to the Question Concerning Technology; Technology and the Character of the Good Life [10 Lectures]

The Problem of Philosophy Today The Battle of the Ancients against the Moderns [5 Lectures]

Text and Reference Books

Text Books

1. Eric Lund, Mogens Pihl and Johannes Slk, A History of European Ideas, Hurst, London, 1971.
2. Select excerpts from the writings of leading European philosophers since Plato (can be had of the teacher)

Readings

1. Alistair J. Sinclair, **What Is Philosophy? An Introduction**, Dunedin Academic Press, 2008.
2. Anthony Kenny, **The Oxford Illustrated History of Western Philosophy**, Oxford, 1994.
3. Bertrand Russell, **A History of Western Philosophy**, Routledge, 2004.
4. Jacob Needleman, **The Heart of Philosophy**, Jeremy P. Tarcher, 2003.
5. Jostein Gaarder, **Sophies Dream**, 1995 (soft copy placed in the library).
6. James L. Christian, **Philosophy, An introduction to the Art of Wonderin**, Wordsworth, 2009.
7. Richard David Precht, **Who am I**, Spiegel & Grau, 2011.
8. Richard Schacht, **Hegel and After: Studies in Continental Philosophy Between Kant and Sartre**, University of Pittsburgh Press, 1975.
9. **Classical Modern Philosophers: Descartes to Kant**, Routledge & Kegan Paul, 1984.
10. Ted Honderich, **The Oxford Companion to Philosophy**, Oxford University Press, 1995.